



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2023 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05350) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Spring 2023**

Courses Audience: **64**

Responses Received: **22**

Response Ratio: **34.4%**

Report Comments

Results were collected during the implementation of a new course evaluation system.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

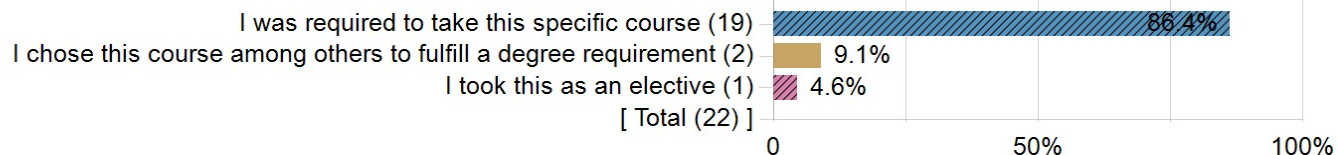
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

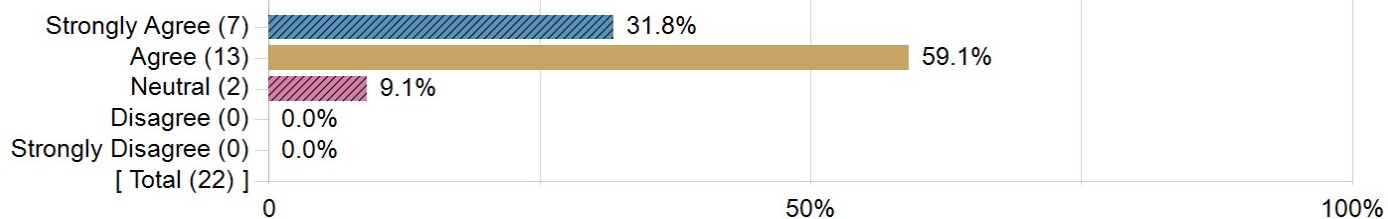
Creation Date: **Friday, June 16, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



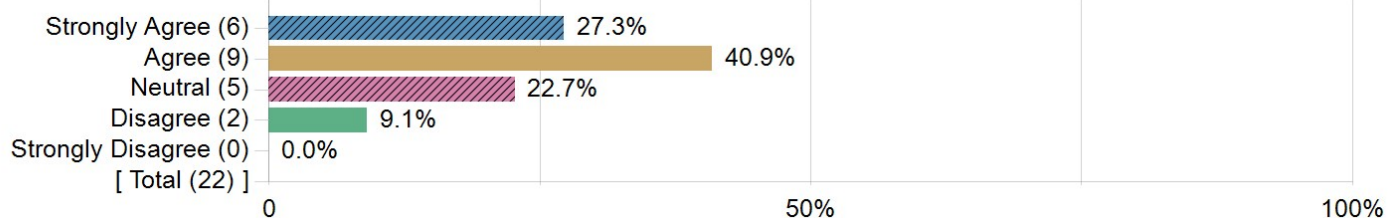
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.23

The course was well organized.



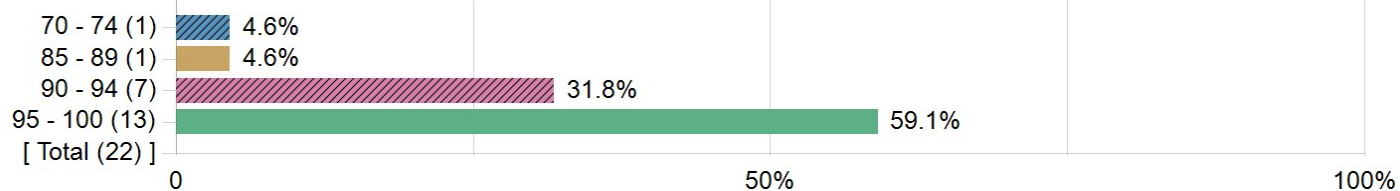
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.86

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



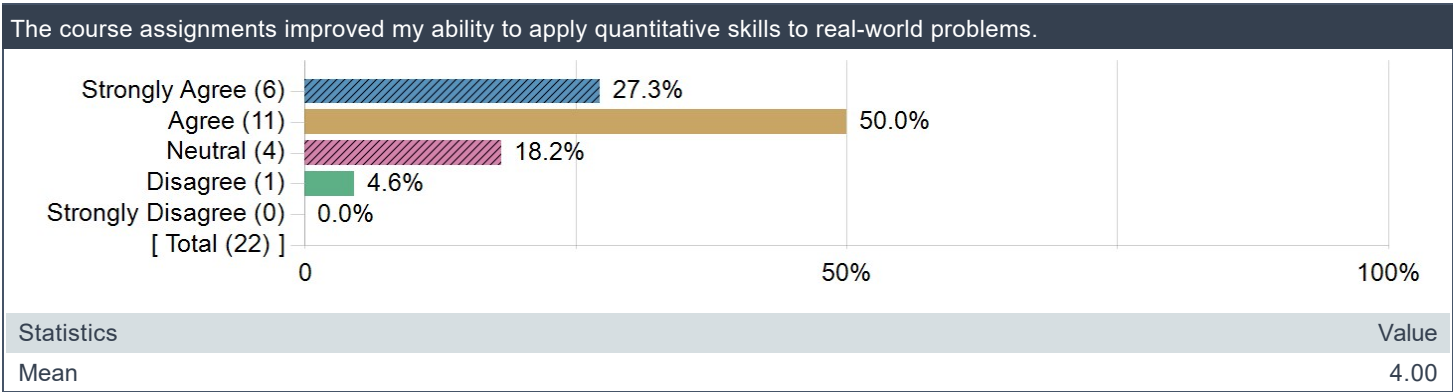
Statistics

Value

Mean

93.73

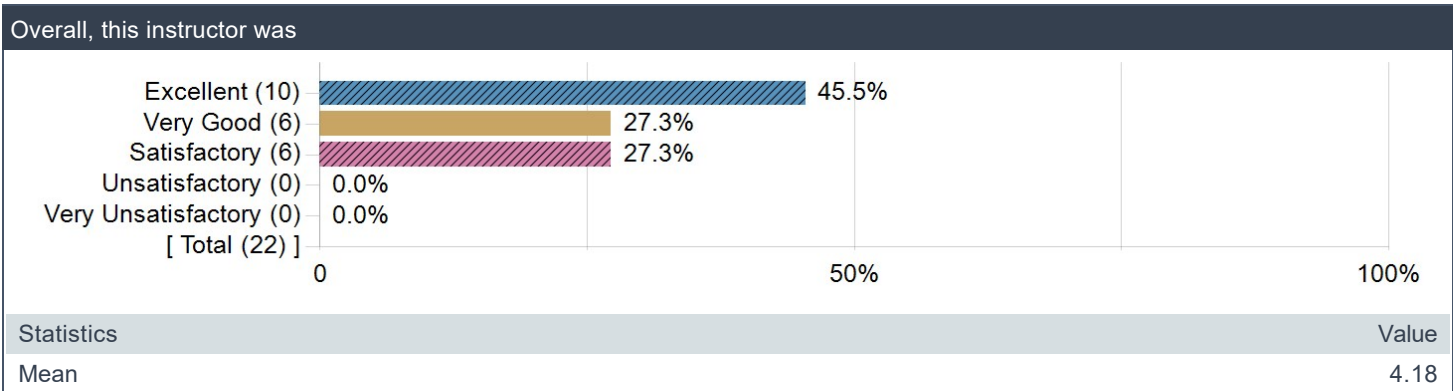
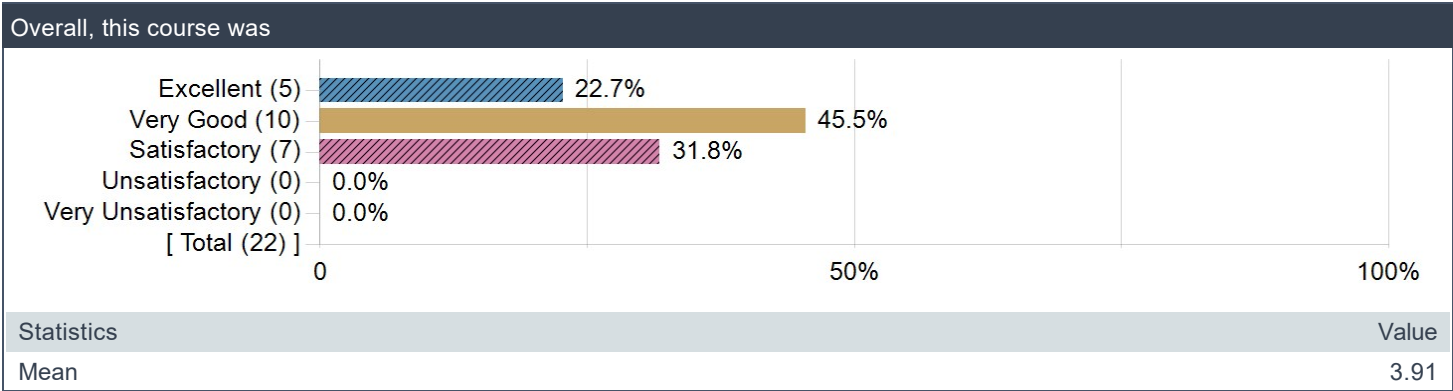
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



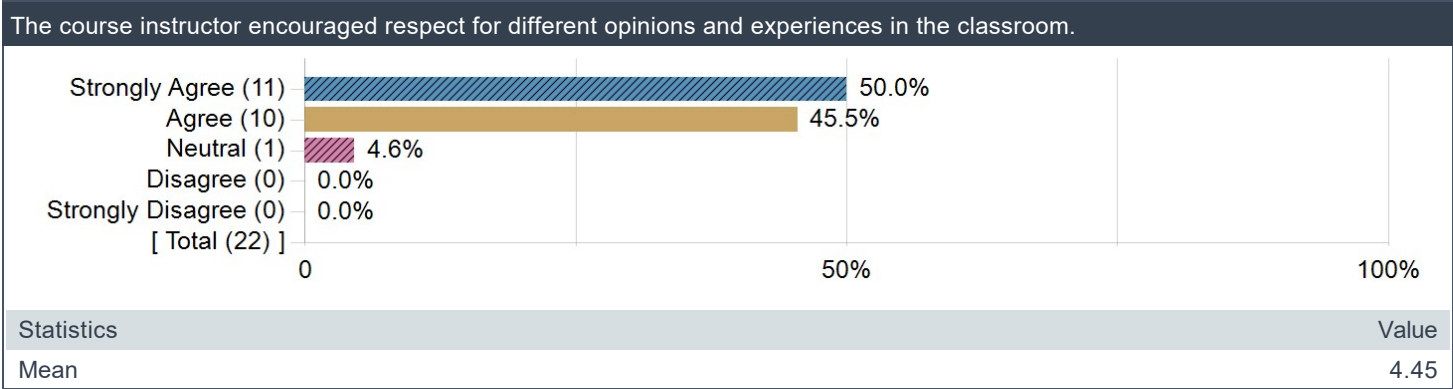
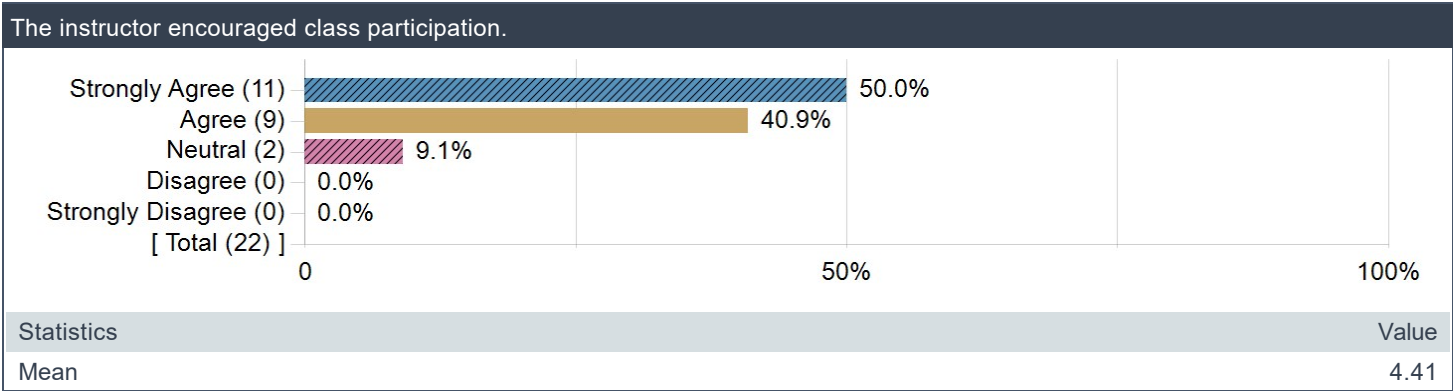
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	45.5%	40.9%	13.6%	0.0%	0.0%	22	4.32
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	50.0%	45.5%	4.5%	0.0%	0.0%	22	4.45
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	36.4%	45.5%	13.6%	4.5%	0.0%	22	4.14
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	27.3%	45.5%	22.7%	4.5%	0.0%	22	3.95
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	50.0%	40.9%	9.1%	0.0%	0.0%	22	4.41

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The homeworks and reviews helped a ton!
the in-class examples were engaging
Homeworks
lots of help from the professor who was very kind and stayed after class to answer every question
i found it most helpful for my learning when we were actively going through code in R. It was a lot more difficult to learn when we just went through slides in class.
I appreciated how Professor Bolfarine explained concepts in detail and walked us through the knowledge checks.
lectures
In class examples
Structure was the same throughout weeks. Professor Bolfarine was very funny and seemed genuinely interested in what he was teaching. Ran code that was related to the homework, so class helped prepare for out of class assignments.
Homeworks were very effective
In class R script examples
Slides being accessible before class & class recordings make this class very accommodating and one that doesn't punish you for missing class some days. Professor Bolfarine is also great at explaining these hard to grasp and complex topics.
Professor Bolfarine's lecturing was the most helpful thing
The instructor was great, and the lecture slides were very helpful in learning.
The recorded lectures were very helpful.
Attending the lectures was the best way to prepare for the class. Lectures are organized and cover the materials of homework and exams.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
I wish we had more practice assignments, because the content was a bit hard to understand.
The homework in this class is extremely difficult and often times take multiple hours.
Exams were challenging
the exams were nothing like the material we discussed in class due to us reviewing more than learning new concepts
It was really hard to focus for the whole 2 hours. I think it would've been helpful if we were at least offered a break somewhere in the class.
I felt that the course sessions were extremely long and it was hard to keep up with everything being taught. I also felt that the course content didn't cover everything needed to be successful at the homeworks. I felt that some content was not taught well to prepare us for midterms and finals.
exam
n/a
Sometimes, the homework would ask conceptual questions or run code that was more complex than lecture.
Keep students engaged better during class
Homeworks towards the end of class were very long and difficult (started out being like 5 questions then later 15 long questions)
I found the final to be very comprehensive and have lots of complex topics, given that we were told the final would not be cumulative but only cover second half of content. Possibly rearranging easier topics to be our last couple of classes will help.
The most challenging were the homeworks, but the TA's were very helpful with those.
The homework assignments were a little abstract but not too challenging, much less than in 301.
We didn't know the exam was cumulative until like a week ago. He told us previously it wouldn't be. That's just not fair to us.
I found the homework to be the most challenging part, but I believe the professor and TAs have done their best to help us through them.

